CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · NCERT-TYPE CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'The Sermon at Benares' is written by: 1

(a) Ruskin Bond **(b)** Anita Desai **(c)** Gordon Hull **(d)** Betty Renshaw

2. The Buddha asked Kisa Gotami to bring: 1

(a) a flower **(b)** gold coins
(c) a handful of mustard seed **(d)** a pot of water

3. 'Sermon' means: 1

(a) a letter **(b)** a religious talk **(c)** a song **(d)** a game

4. The Buddha taught that attachment leads to: 1

(a) sorrow **(b)** fame **(c)** wealth **(d)** power

5. The sermon in the lesson is delivered by: 1

(a) Mahavira **(b)** Gautama Buddha **(c)** Kabir **(d)** Ashoka

6. The condition set by the Buddha was that the seed should be taken from a house: 1

(a) that was near a river **(b)** where a baby was born
(c) where no one had died **(d)** that was rich

7. 'Bereaved' means: 1

(a) rich **(b)** having lost a loved one
(c) famous **(d)** angry

8. Benares is also known as: 1

(a) Ujjain **(b)** Varanasi **(c)** Prayag **(d)** Madurai

9. Kisa Gotami could not find mustard seed because: 1

(a) every house had lost someone **(b)** no one had mustard
(c) people refused **(d)** it was night

10. The mustard seed in the story is a symbol of: 1

(a) wealth **(b)** medicine
(c) a test to teach a truth **(d)** food

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Who was Kisa Gotami? 2

12. What did she realise at the end of her search? 2

13. What does the Buddha say about weeping for the dead? 2

14. Why did Kisa Gotami go from house to house? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Describe Kisa Gotami's state of mind at the death of her son. 3

16. What is the significance of the Buddha's methods? 3

17. How is the lesson relevant today? 3

OR

How did the Buddha respond to Kisa Gotami's request? 3

18. Explain 'life is troubled and brief'. 3

OR

Rewrite in indirect speech: The Buddha said, 'Bring me a handful of mustard seed.' 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Narrate the story of Kisa Gotami in your own words. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between Kisa Gotami and the Buddha. 5

20. Describe how the Buddha helped Kisa Gotami overcome her grief. 5

OR

Describe the role of compassion in the lesson. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND